

What Is Hugo?

Turn Markdown documentation into a static website.

Learning Goals

- Explain how Hugo turns Markdown into a website.
- Identify the files you edit and the files Hugo generates.

Why Use Hugo?

- Write documentation in Markdown and keep it in Git.
- Build a fast website with no PHP server or database.
- Publish the generated files with GitHub Pages.

Where Hugo Fits

- Module 2: implement your API with Laravel and Eloquent.
- Module 3, `1_Docker` : run the API and MySQL in containers.
- Module 3, `2_Hugo` : write documentation and portfolio pages.
- Module 3, `3_Github_io` : publish those pages automatically.

The website explains the API; it does not host the Laravel server.

Source → Build → Website

Markdown + templates + configuration → hugo → public/

- `content/` contains your Markdown source files.
- `public/` contains HTML, CSS, and static files.

Visitors receive these files without running PHP or querying MySQL.

What You Will Edit

Location	Purpose
<code>content/</code>	Markdown pages
<code>static/</code>	Stylesheet and screenshots
<code>hugo.toml</code>	Site title and links
<code>layouts/_default/</code>	Three page templates
<code>archetypes/</code>	Template for new content

Hugo generates `public/` ; edit source files instead of generated HTML.

Reuse Project 1 Documentation

Bring over your endpoint descriptions, request/response examples, and screenshots. The next lesson shows how to convert the Marp formatting.

Preview Locally

```
hugo server -D
```

The server previews locally, including drafts with `-D` .

View the Home Page

Open `http://localhost:1313` in your browser.

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John Doe

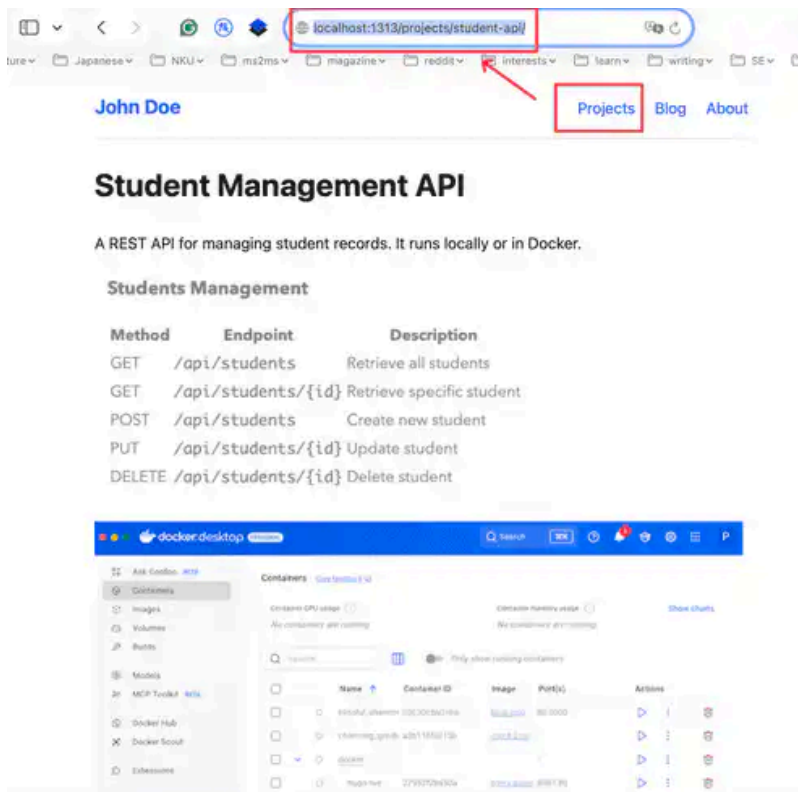
I build REST APIs with Laravel, MySQL, and Docker.

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View a Project Page

Open `http://localhost:1313/projects/student-api/` to view
`content/projects/student-api.md`.



Build the Markdown into Web Pages

```
hugo --minify
```

By default, Hugo writes the generated site to `public/`.

- Draft pages are excluded from this publishable build.
- The `--minify` option removes unnecessary characters from generated files to reduce their size.
- GitHub Actions will run that build after you push source changes.

Example Build

Version and timing will differ on your computer.

```
└─> hugo --minify
Start building sites ...
hugo v0.147.7+extended+withdeploy
darwin/amd64 BuildDate=2025-05-31T12:41:12Z
VendorInfo=brew
```

	EN
Pages	14
Paginator pages	0
Non-page files	0
Static files	3
Processed images	0
Aliases	0
Cleaned	0

Total in 59 ms

Command Summary

```
hugo server -D # preview, including drafts  
hugo --minify # build publishable files in public/
```

Next: run the supplied portfolio example and replace its sample content.